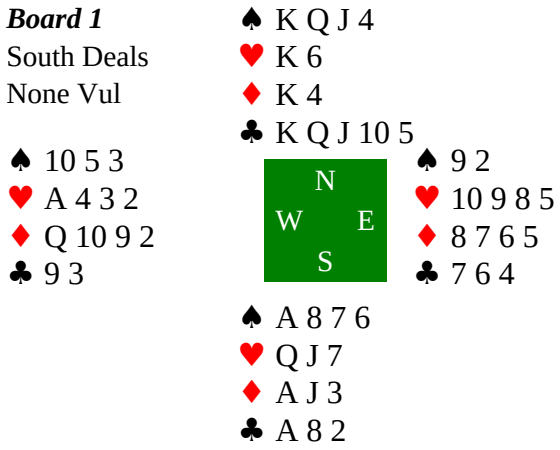
Board 1
South Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♠5

When SOUTH opens 1NT NORTH hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

Board 2
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 9 7 2 ♥ K J 5 3 ♦ K 7 ♣ 7 6 4 2	
♠ Q J 10 6 ♥ 8 2 ♦ 9 5 2 ♣ J 9 8 5		♠ 8 5 4 3 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 8 6 4 ♣ Q 10 3
	♠ A K ♥ A Q 10 9 6 ♦ A Q J 3 ♣ A K	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5NT[3]
Pass	6♥[4]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 2 kings

7NT by South
Lead: ♠Q

SOUTH has a pretty good hand, and when NORTH shows ♥ support she naturally thinks about slam.

She has all four Aces but she wants to know about Kings. Unfortunately she can't start at 5NT because that has a different meaning, so she goes through the 4NT sequence even though she already knows the Ace answer.

Finding NORTH with two Kings was what she wanted.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K 7 ♥ K 9 ♦ A Q J 10 4 ♣ A Q J 7	
♠ Q 10 9 5 ♥ Q 8 5 3 ♦ 9 8 2 ♣ 5 4		♠ J 8 4 3 ♥ J 7 6 2 ♦ 6 3 ♣ 10 9 3
	♠ A 6 2 ♥ A 10 4 ♦ K 7 5 ♣ K 8 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♠
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

7NT by South
Lead: ♠10

NORTH is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when SOUTH shows 13-15 points NORTH wants to be in a slam.

NORTH cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with SOUTH's latest bid being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in NORTH's hand so he bids 7NT.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A K 5 ♥ 7 ♦ Q 10 6 5 3 ♣ K 10 8 4	
♠ J 8 4 3 ♥ 10 9 8 5 3 2 ♦ 2 ♣ 7 5		♠ Q 10 9 7 2 ♥ A Q J 6 ♦ A 8 ♣ 6 3
	♠ 6 ♥ K 4 ♦ K J 9 7 4 ♣ A Q J 9 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]		
All Pass			

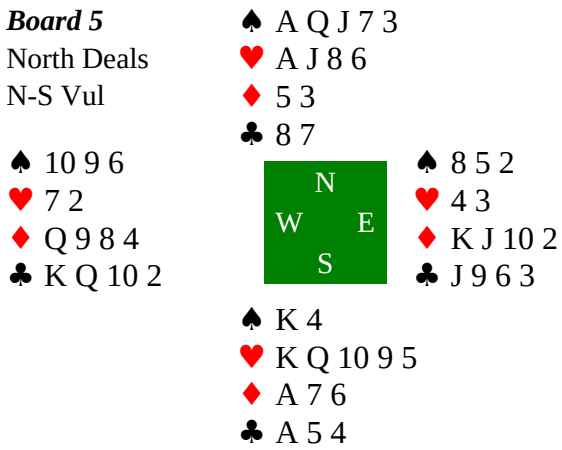
1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♦ by South
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are missing two Aces!

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣K

SOUTH knows NORTH has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, NORTH comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces SOUTH knows there are not enough points for Grand, so she bids 6♥.